METRIC

A-A-20251
January 18, 2002

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CREAM, EGGNOG, HALF-AND-HALF, AND SOUR CREAM

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID). This CID replaces Types VII, VIII, IX, and XII requirements in CID A-A-20013B.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This CID covers cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. PURCHASER NOTES.

2.1 PURCHASERS *shall specify* the following:

- Group(s), type(s), and flavor(s) of cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products required (Sec. 3).

2.2 PURCHASERS *may specify* the following:

- Vitamins added (optional) (Sec. 5.2.3) for Types A-E (Sec. 3).
- Packaging requirements other than commercial (Sec. 9).

3. CLASSIFICATION. The cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall conform to the following list, which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Groups, types, and flavors.

Group I - Pasteurized
Group II - Ultra-pasteurized (Extended Shelf Life Under Refrigeration [ESL])
Group III - Aseptically processed and packaged (Packaged in hermetically sealed containers that maintains commercial sterility under normal nonrefrigerated conditions)

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Types A-E are available with all Groups
Type A - Heavy cream
Type B - Light whipping cream

Type C - Light cream (coffee or table cream)
Flavor 1 - Amaretto
Flavor 2 - Hazelnut
Flavor 3 - Other (Flavor currently commercially available *purchaser shall specify*)

Type D - Eggnog
Type E - Half-and-half

Types F-O are not available with Group II and Group III
Type F - Sour cream
Type G - Sour cream with added sweeteners or flavorings
Type H - Reduced fat sour cream
Type I - Lowfat sour cream
Type J - Nonfat sour cream
Type K - Acidified sour cream
Type L - Acidified sour cream with added sweeteners or flavorings
Type M - Acidified reduced fat sour cream
Type N - Acidified lowfat sour cream
Type O - Acidified nonfat sour cream
Flavor 1 - With chives
Flavor 2 - With bacon and cheddar
Flavor 3 - Other (Flavor currently commercially available *purchaser shall specify*)

4. MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S NOTES. Manufacturer's/distributor's products *shall meet* the requirements of the:

- Salient characteristics (Sec. 5).
- Manufacturer's/distributor's product assurance (Sec. 6).
- Regulatory requirements (Sec. 7).
- Quality assurance provisions (Sec. 8).
- Packaging requirements other than commercial: *as specified by the purchaser* (Sec. 9).

5. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

5.1 Processing. The cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be formulated and packaged in accordance with the requirements of the current edition of the *Grade "A" Pasteurized Milk Ordinance (PMO)* and current good manufacturing practices (21 CFR Part 110), and shall comply with the following Standards of Identity:

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Food nutrient content claims for fat	21 CFR § 101.62
Requirements for foods named by use of a nutrient content claim and a standardized term	21 CFR § 130.10
Heavy cream	21 CFR § 131.150
Light whipping cream	21 CFR § 131.157
Light cream	21 CFR § 131.155
Eggnog	21 CFR § 131.170
Half-and-half	21 CFR § 131.180
Sour cream	21 CFR § 131.160
Acidified sour cream	21 CFR § 131.162

5.2 Pasteurization/Homogenization. All cream, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be pasteurized at a temperature of not less than 75°C (166°F) for a period of time not less than 15 seconds or at a temperature of not less than 66°C (150°F) for a period of time not less than 30 minutes. Eggnog shall be pasteurized at a temperature of not less than 80°C (175°F) for a period of time not less than 25 seconds, 83°C (180°F) for a period of time not less than 15 seconds or 69°C (155°F) for a period of time not less than 30 minutes. All pasteurization equipment shall be properly designed and operated for a time and temperature thereto for microbial destruction. Pasteurization shall be in accordance with general provisions (21 CFR §131.3) and the *Grade "A" PMO*. The cream, eggnog, and half-and-half products shall be homogenized.

5.3 Finished product.

5.3.1 Milkfat content.

Creams and Eggnog

Product	Milkfat content
Heavy cream, Type A	Contains not less than 36 percent milkfat. 1/
Light whipping cream, Type B	Contains not less than 30 percent but less than 36 percent milkfat. 1/ 2/
Light cream, Type C	Contains not less than 18 percent but less than 30 percent milkfat. 1/ 2/
Eggnog, Type D	Contains not less than 6 percent milkfat, not less than 8.25 percent milk solids not fat, and 1 percent egg yolk solids. 1/ 2/
Half-and-half, Type E	Contains not less than 10.5 percent but less than 18 percent milkfat. 1/ 2/

1/ Per reference amount
2/ Identity based on percent milkfat

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5.3.2 **Fat content.**

Sour Creams (Acidified and Cultured)

Product	Milkfat content
Sour cream, Types F and K	Contains not less than 18 percent milkfat. 1/
Sour cream with added sweeteners and flavorings, Types G and L	Contains not less than 18 percent milkfat of the remainder contained by substracting the weight of added ingredients from the weight of the food, but in no case does the food contain less than 14.4 percent milkfat. 1/ 2/ 3/
Reduced fat sour cream, Types H and M	Minimum of 25 percent reduction in total fat. 1/ Contains 13.5 percent or less fat, but not less than 6 percent total. 2/
Lowfat sour cream, Types I and N	Contains 3 grams of fat per 50 grams of food fat. 1/ Contains 6.0 percent or less, but not less than 1.0 percent total fat. 2/
Nonfat sour cream, Types J and O	Contains less than 0.5 grams of fat per 50 grams of food fat. 1/ Contains less than 1 percent total fat. 2/

1/ Per reference amount
2/ Compared to Types F and K
3/ Nutritive sweeteners or bulky flavoring

5.3.3 **Vitamins additional (optional).** When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order for Types A-E, the cream, eggnog, and half-and-half products shall contain 400 International Units (IU) of vitamin D and contain at least 2,000 IU of vitamin A per 946 mL (1 quart) within limits of good manufacturing practice.

5.3.4 **Flavors.** Cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be free from all undesirable and objectionable flavors, and have a pleasingly sweet distinctive individual characteristic flavor. The cream products, Types A-C, shall have a clean, pleasing flavor. The light cream, Type C, may have flavor to a slight degree of cooked, feed, or flat. The eggnog, Type D, shall have a sweet, pleasing flavor ranging from an egg custard-like flavor without spices to moderately strong flavor with rum and nutmeg spice background flavor. The half-and-half, Type E, shall have a fresh, sweet, pleasing flavor. The sour creams, Types F-O shall have a pleasant mild aromatic acid flavor. Flavoring ingredients shall be added at a level sufficient to impart a desirable characteristic typical flavor to the finished product.

5.3.5 **Color and appearance.** Cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be uniformly colored throughout and characterize the type it represents. The cream products shall be uniformly white to light cream color. The eggnog color shall be uniformly off white to yellow and shall be free from mottling. The half-and-half color shall have a white to light cream color.

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The sour creams shall present a clean, natural color, with a smooth, velvety appearance. Natural color may range from a bright white to a light cream color. The surface should appear smooth and dry without excessive whey separation. Flavoring ingredients shall be consistent in size and distribution to produce the desired appearance and appeal of the finished product.

5.3.6 Body and texture. The heavy cream and light whipping cream products shall whip rapidly and retain a satisfactory stiffness. The heavy cream, light whipping cream, and light cream products shall be smooth and uniform. The light cream and half-and-half shall show no evidence of feathering or oiling-off in hot coffee. The eggnog shall be smooth with a creamy consistency and shall show no evidence of separation, ropiness, slimy mouth, or excessive viscosity. The sour creams shall be thick and smooth, uniform, free from lumps, or graininess and spoonable to a soft mound.

5.3.7 Foreign material. Cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and be free from foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

5.4 Shelf life and age requirement. All cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall comply with State and local laws, regulations, or requirements, as applicable.

6. MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S PRODUCT ASSURANCE. The manufacturer/ distributor shall certify that the cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to their own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of conformance.

7. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The delivered cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall comply with the current edition of the *Grade "A" PMO* and with all applicable Federal, State, and local regulations relating to the production, transportation, receiving, processing, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products within the commercial marketplace. These cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall comply with all applicable provisions of the *Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act*, the *Fair Packaging and Labeling Act* and regulations promulgated thereunder.

8. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. All Grade "A" milk plants producing cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products under this CID shall comply with all applicable requirements of the current edition of the *Grade "A" PMO.* The production, transportation, processing, handling, sampling, analysis, labeling, and sale of cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall also comply with said regulation. Cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be obtained from a dairy firm listed in the Food and Drug

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Administration's (FDA) IMS List (*Sanitation Compliance and Enforcement Ratings of Interstate Milk Shippers).* The firm shall also have an Enforcement Rating of 90 or better. The Enforcement Rating indicates the level of the regulatory agency's application of the requirements of the *Grade "A" PMO* to the listed dairy firm. Or, alternatively, a milk plant may have a National Conference on Interstate Milk Shipments (NCIMS) acceptable dairy hazard analysis critical control point (HACCP) plan in place of a conventional sanitation compliance rating and enforcement rating. The above mentioned rated milk plants and their respective regulatory agency's enforcement rating, and/or HACCP listings for milk plants shall be found in the IMS List.

Any testing conducted on cream, eggnog, half-and-half, and sour cream products shall be in compliance with the current edition of the *Grade "A" PMO*, the most current edition of *Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products* of the American Public Health Association, and the most current edition of *Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC INTERNATIONAL.* In addition, all testing shall be conducted by milk laboratories that are listed in the IMS List.

9. PACKAGING. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be commercial unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

10. REFERENCE NOTES.

10.1 Sources of documents.

10.1.1 Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877, telephone (301) 924-7077. Internet address: http://www.aoac.org.**

Copies of the Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products may be obtained from: **American Public Health Association, 800 I Street, NW, Washington, DC 20001, telephone (202) 777-2742. Internet address: http://www.apha.org.**

10.1.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Fair Packaging and Labeling Act are contained in 16 CFR Parts 500 to 503. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954. Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases are made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800 or on the Internet at: http://www.access.gpo.gov/nara.**

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Copies of the current edition of the *Grade "A" Pasteurized Milk Ordinance* and the *Sanitation Compliance and Enforcement Ratings of Interstate Milk Shippers* may be obtained from: **Milk Safety Team (HFS-626), FDA, 200 C Street, SW, Washington, DC 20204, telephone (202) 205-9175 or on the Internet at: http://www.cfsan.fda.gov/~ear/p-nci.html.**

Copies of this CID and beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this CID are available from and/or provided to: **Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243, telephone (202) 720-9939, Fax (202) 690-0102, via E-mail: FQAStaff@usda.gov or on the Internet at: http://www.ams.usda.gov/fv/fvqual.htm.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation and Production Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOD - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
VA - OSS
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PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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